The Last
~~A~~ Night on the Disc Fields ~~The way from the lost~~ 2026 . 7 . 6

~~Quelter of the Haunted Disc Golf Fields.~~ (disc golf fever dream)

I hiked up the hill by hole 3 as the remaining light from the afterglow dwindled. Mom called, which made the ankle-deep grass a mere mild annoyance in comparison. Yes. I'm camping in the park with Smur for our project that's due very soon. I explained, for the 6th? Or was it the 7th, night in a row. I hung up.

Then I squinted and scanned the landscape below surrounding holes 12 and 13 for any signs of movement or glowing light. About the time it normally comes out.

I began triple checking my ammunition. My fingers glided over the rim of each disc in my waistside pack. Two months were more than enough to know them by touch and build that sense of trust and bondage.

This night, the light originated from between the branches of a small cedar tree by hole 11. The memory of once getting the disc stuck there tugged at me, and I sighed with the naive hope that it was still right there. The light grew brighter, then became an orb the size of a shrub, emanating pale green energy. Then with a flash that lighted up the entire field, the light died down and a familiar creature came forth. It was a youngling whose name I never learned to pronance, with obsidian legs of a stag but a fox's face covered with pale green patches of fur, and a bushy tail.

I knew the drill. I pulled out the disc that was its elder sibling, whose face was disfigured by the pawing of a fellow player's dog. I took aim as the green creature picked up my presence and began meandering my way. Tightening my forehand grip, I reminded myself to take conscious control of the release angle to avoid the disc spiralling

into a wobbly anhyzer fall to earth. With all preparations made, I wisked the disc out in a swift motion with determined yet controlled force. It glowed a dim glitchy white probably due to the disfigurement as its green younger counterpart immediately pranced full speed to intercept the disc.

The moment the two collided, there was an explosion of crystal dust which permeated the air. All light went out as the dust washed over me. Then I heard a satisfying "plop" signalling that the disc I had just thrown had dropped onto the grass. Around 10 feet up the hill from H13's teebox, I made a mental note for where to retrieve the disc in the morning. I couldn't imagine the consequences if I also lost this one to an unwitting or purposefull malevolent disc taker.

Probably the marine unrest would be stirring by now, I thought, and began walking around the highest hill then down to the river. Sure enough, dark shadows lurked in the water by the bank of hole 6.

"Come on, show yourselves if you've got the guts! I haven't got all night!" I taunted, with all the confidence I could muster. "Single combat duel!"

In spite of my demand, a pair of misty figures rose from the rippling surface into a misty apparition. A breeze rustled the leaves of the riverside trees aside, allowing the pale waning moonlight to briefly illuminate the arisered creature. The delineation was a pair of twin corpulent fish whose whiskers silently stretched towards the bank. Their movement perfectly symmetric as both fish shared one eye each. I recognised them as Pisces, and wondered if they once belonged to my friend who lost not one but two Pisces drivers to the river when playing hole 5.

The pair of fish wavered along the bank, as if contemplating whether venturing ashore was a valid idea. "Come on." I prompted in a gentle voice, for I have concluded from the many nights of experience that such mindless spirits are all easily swayed. Indeed, came, they did.

I didn't want to risk a direct throw with the river right behind, so I began sidestepping towards the river as I gestured for the mythical fish creatures to also engage in this counterclockwise motion deeper into shore with my left hand while pulling out the trusty midrange that I use as a putter with my right. The fish obliged, as if hypnotized. I felt like the famous ancient Greek (or Roman) Gladiators facing their opponents, forcing them into circling each other by sheer willpower. Then, as I came into the position where my back was to the river and had a safe margin of land behind the creatures, I striked. The putt left my hand in a clean throwing motion, but a gust of wind caught the slightly nose-up disc and lifted it into a leftwards glide. The fish with their googley-eyes stopped and gawked at the disc in stupidity as it landed in the dirt and rolled a meter or two before crashing into a tree. I took the second chance and pulled out another disc and putted with much more spin and determination at the creatures. It was a distance driver, not my first pick to put with, but it sure worked. The fish disintegrated, still in their stupid trance, as their spirit was quelled back into the disc they came from that still lay in the deep, stilty river among the perhaps —— hundred others.

I went and picked up both discs, pretending to be like a chill nonchalant adult despite nobody watching, heart still pounding with lingering excitement. Then my heart missed a beat as a streak of blinding golden light swooshed

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atop the treetops right above me with an ear-splitting sonic boom.

It was the Eagle, or maybe a Phoenix? Anyways, it flies way too high, fast and far for me to catch it. But I'm in training though, perhaps just some day I could craft the perfect hyzer angle...

The eastern sky was preparing to be diluted by the morning light to come as I hiked up the hill to stand atop the highest spot between the teeboxes of holes 4 and 10, where it was just me and the night, the waves of grass shimmering under the moonlight undulating in the wind blowing down into the river, the chirping of crickets and cicadas from the woods. How I wished that feeling could last forever.

As clouds began lighting up upon the western sky and the yellow-green color of the grass began to show, I began roaming the fields the reverse direction along hole 1 then hole 18. For a moment, I thought I had missed the dragon, then remembered how the guys cutting grass told us about coming across a red disc. Another lost one found.

I was gazing at the night above the woods fade into a lighter blue as the first ray of dawn spilled through the treetops, lighting up a marble doorframe standing right next to the basket of hole 13, this time a mere putt away from me. So out of place, but it was calling for me to go, for real this time.

And I knew it was alright. The morning grass looked no different on the other side, but the next night no spirits would come out to the field since I won't be there anymore.

I crossed the threshold to greet the first morning of August, knowing that the memories are still as vivid as ever.